Defense Attorney Simmons

"So like I was saying, bXJ0aW0 helped me turn on the accessibility settings and then I did the rest of the application on my own."

Three smoke rings appear in succession, the small ring passing through the medium ring passing through the large ring. Defense attorney Simmons finishes puffing on his cigar and kicks up his legs onto the desk in front of him.

"Yeah we can't use that as testimony, you'd be offering yourself up on a silver platter. I strongly advise that you do not speak at this trial. Thankfully they can't call bXJ0aW0 because they are charging him too and vice versa. You guys did some real knuckle headed shit in these cases. I am pretty sure we can win the case for Oros, and then get the case against bXJ0aW0 thrown out. Iwa, check out relevant case law on that, I think there are a few paths we can go there and we want the best one for this judge."

"You need that by tonight or is tomorrow morning good?"

"Let's say tonight. And bXJ0aW0, just one more time, when you were sitting in the waiting area, do you know if your static electricity protocol would have been affecting any sensors at the testing facility?"

"I guess if I got close enough, yeah. There might have been a few cameras I got close to and obviously terminal 17."

"So just thinking out loud, the static electricity that you had on you could have built up on Oros. Then Oros goes to take the exam and he has electricity on him with your electronic signature."

"That's true."

"So in theory, we could sow some doubt in the reading that way but the prosecution might go the calculation route and I don't think we win there."

"That's beyond me, Simmons, but you're the lawyer."

"Iwa, check with a mathematician on those calculations, it might be a nice back pocket strategy."

"Oros, we will get back to you in a moment. bXJ0aW0, when I was reviewing your background I saw what I assume are multiple racially motivated charges that you were convicted for, is that correct?"

"Shit Simmons, does the file just say RACIST at the top or are you able to read basic language?"

"Hey I am just trying to clarify here, we are on the same side."

"Sorry. It's just the number of jobs I have lost because of that bullshit is way too many."

"As I was about to say, one of the witnesses that I am sure the prosecutor will call should back up the fact that all of your previous cases were racially charged which should make you look better in front of the jury."

"That shit really works? No wonder you get paid the big bucks"

"Boss, you want me to double check that assumption?"

"Yeah that's a good idea. What I am most worried about is if they have feed footage of Oros taking the test. From what I know, the cameras usually have a wide angle so you can see it but will zoom in on particular individuals if they are doing anything suspicious. If we are lucky, there won't be any cameras in focus for when bXJ0aW0 runs over to Oros."

"Before I got up, there was a person vomiting a few seats away. Would that help?"

"Depends. If it zoomed in enough then we wouldn't see you leave, if it's just a little too wide we might have footage of you standing up and heading to Oros. Iwa we hear anything about the feed?"

"Nothing yet, but if I had to bet, I don't think there will be any feed. Normally, the DA's office would give me notice by now but I haven't heard anything."

"Well they have the damned feed of the two of them walking into the Office of Universal Basic Income."

"That technically doesn't prove anything, boss."

"It technically puts bXJ0aW0 into the room with Oros during the UBI exam. And that means we have a known criminal android with the means and motive to help his friend cheat. It doesn't exactly look good, Iwa."

"You're not wrong, but we've seen worse."

"Well yeah, of course we've seen worse. But android racism is easy and everywhere. If we don't have an android on the jury we are fucked. Capital F-U-C-K-E-D."

"I get it."

"Don't forget to get the psychoergometer analyses of energy graph profiles for war veterans done. That will be key evidence during cross. I also need a mathematician to help me with the probabilities that will come up when we are discussing the readings from the psychoergometer. Who's our math guy again?"

"Dr. Rostislov, sir."

"Perfect. I feel like we are missing something though. We will have the witness of the clerk that checked in Oros for sure but she will be a nothingburger. Same goes with the security guards that were there when you were scanned in, they won't have any useful evidence. So just to confirm, Oros you finished the application and the two of you went to the bar and there isn't anything else relevant to the case after that point?"

"Well…"

"We did say…"

At this point Oros and bXJ0aW0 get close and start whispering to each other. The two converse for a while with a lot of gesticulation and the occasional bit of laughter. Oros breaks the huddle first and walks over to stand in front of Simmons.

"So there's a small thing. So we were at the bars, 5 songs deep, 12 beers in. These two girls come in and start singing the songs and drinking beers as fast as us. We get a private room and really sing and drink our hearts out. Things get a little spotty for me, bXJ0aW0 is blackout by this point, but I remember next thing we are getting shawarma. bXJ0aW0 is telling the girl he is into about what he did to help me today which he never does but he never gets that drunk and he realizes he broke the rule for me. I'm pretty sure the girl I was with didn't hear anything."

"..."

"..."

"Iwa."

"Yeah, boss?"

"Who is the witness that the prosecution is calling 7th?"

"Britany Gxiiiigop."

"Oros, your whole case rides on what you're about to say. Is Britany the girl you were talking to or the girl that bXJ0aW0 was talking to."

"I was chilling with Britany."

"Holy shit. You motherfucker. This whole case almost sunk because of that. bXJ0aW0 you idiot why would you tell someone that."

"... I was really drunk. Like I disabled my safety circuits drunk."

"Well if I didn't find this shit out today we were royally fucked. bXJ0aW0 if your case was first, we would be fucked five ways to friday. And then Oros would go down the fucking drain as well. Luckily prosecution is accusing bXJ0aW0 of being an accomplice so the main crime goes to Oros saving our fucking asses. Do you guys understand the giant fucking bullet we just dodged? Iwa I don't think they fucking get it."

"Should I get the pamphlet boss?"

"Get it later. For now I want these two gentlemen to really sit with how lucky they got."

"Okay I'll bite Simmons, why is it so bad."

"bXJ0aW0 confessed the crime and if his girl was testifying during your trial they would have the smoking gun that he did help cheat on your application."

"Yeah that is fucked."

"No shit. Normally cases like this are open shut for the Commonwealth, but star after star keeps aligning for the two of you. For example, witness five saw bXJ0aW0 approach Oros at the terminal, but by some miracle the witness is such a racist dipshit his social profiles are filled with anti-android rhetoric. The DA has no choice but to call this guy, as it's his best evidence putting bXJ0aW0 near the terminal, but for us it's the perfect witness to

continue showing the jury this whole thing is racially motivated. Don't go out buying lotto tickets as y'all used up all of your luck in this case."

Oros and bXJ0aW0 turn to each other and burst out laughing, remembering that they bought lotto tickets on the way to the UBI appointment.

"What's so funny? This racism angle is the foundation of our case. Like I said, the two of you seem to be made of luck. The expert witness for the psychoergometer analysis? Her PhD thesis is literally about android discrimination. I can't make this shit up."

"We were just laughing cause we bought lotto tickets at the tube station right before we got to the Building of Examinations and Other Similar Matters."

Simmons starts pacing the room, his compound eyes taking in anything and everything: Iwa, Oros, bXJ0aW0, the various case files, the projected timeline of events with key evidence and witnesses marked. Something was buzzing at the base of his antenna, just behind his consciousness.

"Iwa we're missing something. Walk us through our defense from the top."

Piece by piece, Iwa proceeds through the various pieces of evidence and planned witness testimony. The buzz in Simmons' head was increasing in intensity, and just as Iwa started discussing the energy graphs, a cascade of neural activity exploded in Simmons' cranium.

"Oros! Does your netpad have PTSD software and sensor package upgrades?"

"Kinda. I have a cracked version I downloaded from the darknet and bXJ0aW0 helped me install some after market sensors. I won't get in trouble right? I can't afford the real deal…"

"If your netpad has the data we need, the firm will cover the costs of paying the company associated with the cracked software. So, Oros, do you have data covering the timeframe of the UBI application?"

Oros starts interacting with his netpad and after a few minutes finds the data buried deep in the settings of the PTSD software.

"Looks like it recorded a spike during the UBI. But why does that matter? Can't I just take the stand?"

"No, if you take the stand, then the prosecution will be able to ask you directly if you received assistance. We have built the case so far on generic veteran energy profiles but this can prove you had an episode without you taking the stand. Iwa, I want this data extracted and copied to the court's servers immediately. This is just the curveball we needed to throw off prosecution during discovery."

"Will do. I also just had a thought. Oros, the staffer that checked you in, what did they say about disability accommodations?"

"She just said to activate the PTSD setting or something."

"Did she mention anything about a staffer offering to help you set that up?"

"Nah don't think so."

"Iwa if you keep coming up with insights like that, your internship might just turn into a full time position sooner than you think. Ok let's take a dinner break, sometimes you have to stop when you're ahead. Let it percolate. You guys good with spicy noodles? I know a good spot with hand pulled noodles, real eggs inside too."

Iwa, Oros, and bXJ0aW0 all nod their consent, and with that the four of them leave the law office and head towards the noodle shop.